

REMEMBER THIS RULEBOOK

In order to make automations reliable (and not annoying), follow this guide:

1. **Start with reminders, not destructive actions.**
Automations should protect you from mistakes, not amplify them.
2. **Name tasks like you're explaining them to Future You.**
Task Scheduler fills up fast.
3. **Use one trigger + one script file** whenever possible.
Instead of 10 tasks launching 10 apps, create one batch file that launches everything, then schedule one thing.
4. **Test manually once** before trusting it.
Task Scheduler lets you run tasks immediately (schtasks /run exists for this too).
5. **Be security-aware.**
Scheduled tasks are a common persistence technique for malware; don't blindly import task XMLs or run scripts you don't understand.

- Task Scheduler → trigger "At log on" → action "Start a program" → point to [WorkStart.bat](#).

Example 2: "Weekly Downloads cleanup" (non-destructive version)

Instead of deleting everything, move older files into an archive folder.

```
@echo off
set DL=%USERPROFILE%\Downloads
set ARC=%USERPROFILE%\Downloads\_Archive
if not exist "%ARC%" mkdir "%ARC%"
```

```
echo Moving files to archive...
move "%DL%\*.pdf" "%ARC%" >nul 2>&1
move "%DL%\*.docx" "%ARC%" >nul 2>&1
move "%DL%\*.xlsx" "%ARC%" >nul 2>&1
echo Done.
```

Schedule it weekly Sunday evening with Task Scheduler.

Fast Track note: keep destructive automations (deletes) for later, once you're confident you won't nuke something important.

5) Power Automate + Task Scheduler

Here's the cheat code: Power Automate can run flows via URLs/shortcuts, and Microsoft explicitly notes desktop flows can be

triggered from sources like the Windows Run dialog and Windows Task Scheduler.

Meaning:

- Task Scheduler handles "when"
- Power Automate handles "what" (clicking through UI steps)

Step-by-step: Schedule a Power Automate flow to run daily

1. Create the Power Automate flow.
2. Enable running it via desktop shortcut or run URL.
3. In Task Scheduler:
 - Trigger: Daily 8:00 PM
 - Action: Start a program → call the shortcut / URL trigger method (as documented).
4. Test by running the task manually once.

Use cases:

- Download a report from a portal every evening
- Move that file into a dated folder
- Send a notification (Power Automate can chain into cloud flows if you use that ecosystem)

6) Three "do this today" automations (high impact, low risk)

Automation A: "Shutdown/quiet mode" for students

If you keep studying late and forget to shut down, create a nightly reminder or auto shutdown.

- Task Scheduler → trigger: Daily 1:00 AM
 - Action: run a shutdown command (or show a message/launch a reminder app)
- Task Scheduler supports time-based triggers and actions like starting a program.

(If you prefer a gentler approach: schedule a reminder app launch instead of a forced shutdown.)

Automation B: "Weekly maintenance check" without fake cleaners

Schedule Windows settings pages to open so you actually do maintenance.

- Weekly: Sunday 7 PM
 - Action: open Storage settings / Windows Security
- This builds routine without installing third-party junk.

Automation C: "Backup nudge" (lightweight, realistic)

If you don't have a real backup system yet, schedule a prompt:

- Open your backup folder / external drive reminder
- Or open your cloud sync folder

A reminder you follow beats a perfect backup plan you never start. 